



AI OPERATIONAL **READINESS**

Bridging AI Access and AI Accountability

DISCOVERY **WORKBOOK**

*Understanding Where AI Can Create
Value Responsibly*



by Chloe Devine

AI STRATEGY • GOVERNANCE • OPERATIONAL READINESS

VERSION 2.0

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Discovery Overview

Purpose

This workbook is designed to help organizations identify where AI can create value responsibly by examining:



People



Process



Technology



Governance

Guiding Philosophy: *AI Operational Readiness begins by understanding work, not by selecting tools.*

What We're Looking For

Identify	Understand	Evaluate
Friction	Workflows	Opportunities
Repetition	Bottlenecks	Risks
Handoffs	Data	Human Oversight
Pain Points	Dependencies	Business Impact

Guiding Principles

- | | |
|-------------------------------|--|
| ✓ Start with work, not tools | ✓ Preserve opportunities based on value and risk |
| ✓ Focus on outcomes, not hype | ✓ Adopt AI responsibly and measurably |

This workbook helps organizations:

- | | |
|---------------------|---------------------------|
| ✓ Identify friction | ✓ Evaluate opportunities |
| ✓ Understand work | ✓ Preserve accountability |



Discovery Mode

Choose the discovery lens based on the current state of the work.

Proposed AI	Existing or In-Flight AI
Understand how the work happens today	Reconstruct how the AI-enabled work actually operates
Identify friction, pain, dependencies, and business need	Trace workflow, AI use, dependencies, oversight, evidence, and ownership
Determine whether AI is an appropriate opportunity	Identify operational gaps, risks, workarounds, and improvement needs
Output: Opportunity signals and current-state observations	Output: Operational findings and current-state observations

Both modes begin with the work as it happens – not with the AI tool.



People

Understanding how work gets done

Key Questions

- Where do teams spend the most time?
- What work feels repetitive?
- Where are handoffs painful?
- What frustrates employees?
- Where do people spend time gathering information?
- What work requires constant context switching?
- What knowledge lives only in people's heads?

Observations

Signal

-
-

Pattern

-
-
-

Opportunity

-
-
-

Opportunity Signals

Repetition • Manual effort • Context switching • Rework • Delays • Knowledge gaps



Process

Understanding how work moves

Key Questions

- What workflows exist?
- Where are bottlenecks occurring?
- Which approvals create delays?
- What work is duplicated?
- Which tasks require manual coordination?
- What information must be copied between systems?
- Where do errors or rework commonly occur?
- Where does the way work happens differ from the documented or expected process?
- What workarounds have become part of normal operations?

Observations

Bottleneck

-

Pattern

-

-

-

Opportunity

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-

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Opportunity Signals

Manual effort • Rework • Delays • Duplicate steps • Approval friction • Handoffs • Waiting



Technology

Understanding what tools enable work

Key Questions

- What tools are currently used to complete this work?
- Where are employees already using AI or automation?
- Is Microsoft Copilot, ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, or another tool available?
- What data, documents, or knowledge sources does the work depend on?
- How easy is it for teams to access the information they need?
- Which systems do not connect well today?
- Where do employees copy, paste, export, or manually move information?
- What tool limitations create friction?
- What information are people repeatedly extracting or copying?
- What does this AI-enabled work depend on in order to function?
- Which of these dependencies can change independently of the workflow?

Observations

Constraint

-
-

Pattern

-
-
-

Opportunity

-
-
-

Opportunity Signals

Disconnected systems • Manual data movement • Poor search • Repeated copy/paste • Low tool adoption • Shadow AI use • Data access barriers



Governance

Understanding where accountability lives

Key Questions

- Where is human review required?
- Which decisions require a human to remain accountable?
- What information is sensitive?
- What happens if this work is wrong?
- Who approves outputs?
- Who owns the process?
- Who has the authority to intervene or stop the process?
- What decisions affect customers?
- Where are regulations involved?
- What risks concern leadership?
- Which decisions would have significant consequences if they were to go wrong?
- What assumptions or conditions does the current process rely on to operate safely or appropriately?
- Have any of those conditions changed?

Observations

Risk

-
-

Pattern

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Opportunity

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-
-

Opportunity Signals

Sensitive information • Human review • Compliance obligations • Regulatory exposure • Customer impact • Approval requirements • High-consequence decisions • Missing ownership



Measurement

Understanding how success is evaluated

Key Questions

- How is this work measured today?
- What outcomes matter most?
- What does “better” look like?
- What metrics already exist?
- Where is performance hard to measure?
- What would indicate AI is creating value?
- What would indicate AI is creating unintended consequences, risk or rework?
- What evidence would leadership need before scaling?
- What important questions about this work are difficult to answer today because the necessary evidence isn’t captured?

Observations

Gap

-
-

Pattern

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-
-

Opportunity

-
-
-

Opportunity Signals

Unclear success metrics • Manual reporting • Anecdotal value • Hidden rework • Quality issues • Review burden • Adoption uncertainty • Missing baseline • No scale criteria



Adoption

Understanding how change becomes durable

Key Questions

- Where are employees already experimenting with AI?
- What teams are most receptive to change?
- What concerns or resistance exist?
- Where do people lack confidence using AI?
- How has AI changed the work rather than simply automated it?
- Has AI reduced effort or shifted effort to reviewers?
- What new skills or behaviors are required?
- How are managers supporting adoption?
- How are successes and lessons being shared?
- What do users do when they don't trust the AI output?

Observations

Barrier

-
-

Pattern

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Opportunity

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-
-

Opportunity Signals

Shadow AI uses • Resistance • Low trust • Review burden • Training gaps • Uneven adoption • Key-person dependency • Informal workarounds • Knowledge silos • Localized Successes



AI Continuity & Resilience

Identify where AI dependency could create operational fragility

Key Questions

- What AI-enabled workflows depend on a specific model, vendor, API, or platform?
- What happens if the primary model becomes unavailable for 24 hours?
- What happens if it is unavailable for 7 days?
- What happens if access is permanently restricted?
- What business processes stop functioning?
- What processes degrade gracefully?
- What processes can continue manually?
- What workflows still require retained human expertise?
- Has the organization preserved enough knowledge and staffing capacity to recover?
- Has the fallback or manual process been tested recently?

Observations

Constraint

-
-

Pattern

-
-
-

Opportunity

-
-
-

Opportunity Signals

- Single-model dependency • No fallback path • Manual process no longer documented • Human expertise reduced*
- Critical workflow depends on AI • Vendor/API access risk • Recovery owner unclear*



Escalation & Response

Understanding how issues are managed

Key Questions

- How are issues identified?
- Who is notified?
- What information must be preserved?
- What would trigger a pause or shutdown?
- How are incidents communicated?
- Who has authority to intervene?
- What lessons are captured afterward?
- How are near misses identified and reported?
- What decisions and/ or thresholds would trigger escalation?
- Who can pause or override the process?
- What happens while an issue or escalation is unresolved?

Observations

Failure Point

-
-

Pattern

-
-
-

Opportunity

-
-
-

Opportunity Signals

Missed handoffs • Delayed decisions • Escalation confusion • Incident uncertainty • Silent failures • Missing Evidence • Ownership gaps • No pause criteria



Ownership

Understanding who is accountable

Key Questions

- Who owns this work today?
- Who would own AI-enabled workflows?
- Who can propose, approve, implement, and communicate changes to the process or AI-enabled workflow?
- Who is accountable for outcomes?
- Who is responsible for monitoring performance?
- Who responds when issues occur?
- Which decisions require escalation?
- Where are responsibilities unclear?
- What dependencies exist across teams?
- Where does accountability fall between organizational boundaries?

Observations

Ambiguity

-
-

Pattern

-
-
-

Opportunity

-
-
-

Opportunity Signals

Shared responsibility • Missing ownership • Role confusion • Cross-functional dependencies • Approval bottlenecks • Escalation uncertainty • Competing priorities • Organizational silos



AI Operational Readiness Themes

Synthesizing what we heard

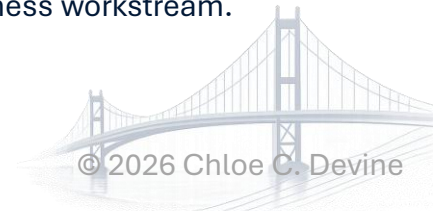
Domain	Observation	Pattern	AI Opportunity/ Operational Finding
People	<i>Pain Points</i>		
Process	<i>Bottlenecks</i>		
Technology	<i>Constraints</i>		
Governance	<i>Risks</i>		
Measurement	<i>Gaps</i>		
Adoption	<i>Barriers</i>		
Continuity	<i>Constraints / Fragility</i>		
Escalation	<i>Failure points</i>		
Ownership	<i>Ambiguities</i>		

Next Step

Translate themes into AI opportunities and operational findings.

AI opportunities: prioritize based on frequency, pain level, complexity, AI fit, risk, and business impact.

Operational findings: route to the appropriate design, governance, evidence, or operational-readiness workstream.





AI OPERATIONAL **READINESS**

Bridging AI Access and AI Accountability

OPPORTUNITY PRIORITIZATION MATRIX

*Translating Themes into
High-Impact AI Opportunities*



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Prioritization Matrix Overview

Purpose

The matrix answers: “Of all the AI opportunities we heard, which ones are worth pursuing first?”

Opportunity	Source Theme	Frequency	Pain Level	Complexity	AI Fit	Risk	Business Impact	Continuity Risk	Priority
...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...

Scoring: Use a simple 1-5 scale

Frequency

1 = Rare, 5 = Happens constantly

Pain Level

1 = Minor annoyance, 5 = Major friction

Complexity

1 = Easy to implement, 5 = Hard to implement

AI Fit

1 = Weak Fit, 5 = Strong Fit

Risk

1 = Low Risk, 5 = High Risk

Business Impact

1 = Low Value, 5 = High Value

Continuity Risk*

1 = Low Risk, 5 = High Risk

Priority Formula

Priority Score = Frequency + Pain Level + AI Fit + Business Impact – Complexity – Risk

The Priority Score supports comparison across opportunities; it does not replace practitioner judgment.

Priority Labels

Score Priority

12+ High

8-11 Medium

7 or below Low

Example Row:

Opportunity	Source Theme	Frequency	Pain Level	Complexity	AI Fit	Risk	Business Impact	Priority
Automate meeting summary drafts	People/ Adoption	5	3	2	5	2	4	13 (High)

***Continuity Risk** is tracked separately and does not affect the Priority Score. It identifies operational dependencies that should be addressed if the opportunity advances.

Scoring

Factor	Score
Frequency	1 – Rare/ occasional 2 - Monthly 3 - Weekly 4 - Daily 5 – Multiple times per day or constant
Pain Level	1 – Minor inconvenience; work is generally manageable 2 – Noticeable friction or occasional frustration 3 – Meaningful inefficiency affecting productivity 4 – Significant bottleneck, or rework, or delay 5 – Major operational pain affecting outcomes, quality, or customer experience
AI Fit	1 – Weak fit; AI adds little value 2 – Possible fit with human review 3 – Reasonable fit with human review 4 – Strong fit for assistive use 5 – Excellent fit; repeatable, language/knowledge-heavy, high-volume work
Business Impact	1 – Low value / convenience only 2 – Small efficiency gain 3 – Meaningful team-level improvement 4 – Significant business value 5 – Strategic, financial, customer, or operational impact
Continuity Risk <i>Tracked separately from the Priority Score to identify operational dependencies that should be addressed if the opportunity advances.</i>	1 – AI outage causes inconvenience only. Work continues with little disruption. 2 – Work slows, but the team has a clear manual workaround or fallback tool. 3 - Workflow slows or causes manual workaround 4 – Major disruption. Customer, operational, compliance, or revenue impact is likely if outage lasts beyond 24-48 hours. 5 – Critical failure. Workflow stops, key expertise is unavailable, or the organization cannot recover without significant external help.

Complexity Score

Calculate complexity from 5 factors, each scored 1-5. Complexity Score = average of the five complexity factors.

Complexity Factor	Score
Process Change	1 - Minimal or no workflow change required 2 - Small adjustment to existing work 3 - Moderate redesign affecting one team 4 - Significant changes involving multiple teams 5 - Major transformation of workflows across organization
Technical Integration	1 - No integration required 2 - One system connection 3 - Several systems connected 4 - Multiple complex integrations 5 - Enterprise-wide integration effort
Data Readiness	1 – Clean, accessible, structured data already exists 2 – Minor preparation required 3 – Some gaps or quality concerns 4 – Significant cleanup or access issues 5 – Data unavailable, fragmented, or poorly understood
Stakeholder Coordination	1 – Single owner or team 2 – Two teams involved 3 – Several stakeholders need alignment 4 – Cross-functional coordination required 5 – Enterprise-wide coordination and governance required
Change Management	1 – Little to no training required 2 – Minor communications and training 3 – Moderate changes in behavior or skills 4 – Significant adoption effort required 5 – Major organizational change initiative

Score Range	Complexity
1.0 - 1.9	Low
2.0 - 2.9	Low-Moderate
3.0 – 3.9	Moderate
4.0 – 4.5	High
4.6 – 5.0	Very High

Example:

$$(4+3+2+4+3) / 5 = 3.2$$



Risk Score

Calculate risk from 5 factors, each scored 1-5. Risk Score = the average of the five risk factors.

Risk Factor	Score
Data Sensitivity	1 – Public Information 2 – Internal Information 3 – Confidential business information 4 – Sensitive customer or employee information 5 – Highly regulated or legally protected information
Decision Consequence	1 – Minor inconvenience; easily reversible 2 – Localized operational impact; readily remediated 3 – Moderate business impact requiring remediation 4 – Significant financial, customer, or reputational impact; difficult to reverse 5 – Severe legal, regulatory, safety, or brand consequence; difficult or impossible to reverse
Oversight & Accountability Requirement	1 – Human review optional 2 – Human review recommended 3 – Human approval normally expected 4 – Human approval required 5 – Human accountability legally or operationally mandatory
External Exposure	1 – Internal-only 2 – Limited audience 3 – Broad internal use 4 – Customer or partner-facing 5 – Public or regulatory exposure
Compliance / Reputation	1 – Minimal concerns 2 – Low concerns 3 – Moderate concerns 4 – Significant exposure 5 – High regulatory or reputational consequences

Score Range	Risk
1.0 - 1.9	Low
2.0 - 2.9	Low-Moderate
3.0 - 3.9	Moderate
4.0 - 4.5	High
4.6 - 5.0	Very High

Example:

$$(4+3+2+4+3) / 5 = 3.2$$



Opportunity Drivers vs Implementation Friction

Priority Score Components

Opportunity Drivers (+)

- Frequency
- Pain Level
- AI Fit
- Business Impact

Implementation Friction (-)

- Complexity
- Risk

Continuity Risk – tracked separately as an operational dependency indicator.

Priority Score

- Opportunity Drivers – Implementation Friction

Priority	Recommended Action
High	Advance for classification and design
Medium	Refine, investigate, or defer
Low	Hold or revisit later

Example Opportunity Profiles

Opportunity	Priority	Notes
Meeting summary drafts	High	Quick win
Knowledge search assistant	High	Strong AI fit
Contract review automation	Medium	Higher risk
Automated customer refunds	Low	High consequence and risk



Opportunity Prioritization Themes

Translating opportunities into action

Component	Purpose
Opportunity Drivers	Identify value
Implementation Friction	Understand effort and risk
Priority Score	Balance value and friction
Recommended Action	Guide next steps

Next Steps

Advance selected opportunities to AI use-case classification to identify the capability pattern before designing the future-state workflow.





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Bridging AI Access and AI Accountability

AI USE CASE CATEGORIES

*Translating Business Problems
into AI Patterns*



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Framework Overview

Understanding how AI problems become repeatable patterns

Purpose

AI use cases are often unique in context but repetitive in pattern. This framework helps teams classify opportunities into common categories that can guide design, governance, and implementation.

A use case may combine multiple capability patterns. Classify the primary pattern and any supporting patterns needed to perform the work.

Why It Matters

Organizations frequently say:

“We need AI.”

The more useful question is:

“What kind of AI capability does this work require?”

Guiding Philosophy

Business problems are often unique in context but repetitive in pattern.



Knowledge Use Cases

Understanding and finding information

Category	Purpose
Search	Locate information
Summarization	Condense information
Extraction	Convert documents into structured data
Translation	Adapt language or formats

Examples

- *Meeting notes*
- *Policies*
- *Contracts*
- *Knowledge bases*

Opportunity Signals

Search burden • Tribal knowledge • Duplicate effort • Repeated questions • Spreadsheet dependency • Context switching • Manual review

Why This Matters

Knowledge work often begins with finding, understanding, and organizing information before decisions are made.



Content Use Cases

Creating and organizing information

Category	Purpose
Draft	Create first versions
Classification	Categorize content
Rewriting	Improve tone or clarity
Tagging	Organize information

Examples

- *Emails*
- *Reports*
- *Job descriptions*
- *Customer communications*

Opportunity Signals

Drafting • Rewriting • Classification • Tagging • Communication burden • Inconsistent outputs • Manual documentation

Why This Matters

Content work benefits from improving consistency, speed, and quality rather than replacing human authorship.



Analysis Use Cases

Supporting decisions

Category	Purpose
Recommendations	Suggest actions
Pattern Detection	Identify trends
Decision Support	Surface insights
Risk Detection	Highlight anomalies

Examples

- Incident reports*
- Customer feedback*
- Financial analysis*

Opportunity Signals

Pattern recognition • Risk assessment • Decision support • Trend analysis • Reporting burden • Insight generation

Why This Matters

Analysis use cases help humans make better decisions rather than transferring accountability to AI.



Workflow Use Cases

Coordinating work

Category	Purpose
Routing	Direct work
Monitoring	Watch thresholds
Escalation Support	Surface issues
Notifications	Trigger actions

Examples

- *Ticketing*
- *Service Requests*
- *Compliance reviews*

Opportunity Signals

Routing • Monitoring • Notifications • Escalation triggers • Bottlenecks • Waiting • Coordination burden

Why This Matters

Workflow use cases improve how work moves across people, teams, and systems.



Agentic Use Cases

Executing multi-step tasks

Category	Purpose
Tool-Using Assistant	Interacts with systems or tools to complete bounded tasks
Guided Workflow	Assists a human through defined steps
Multi-Step Agent	Performs a sequence across steps/tools
Autonomous Agent	Independently selects and executes actions within defined authority.

Examples

- *HR onboarding*
- *Customer service*
- *Procurement*

Opportunity Signals

Multi-step processes • Cross-system work • Repeated approvals • Coordination overhead • Manual orchestration

Why This Matters

As AI takes on multi-step work or execution authority, governance must address the scope of authority, human intervention, escalation, and the consequencea or autonomous action.



Extraction Explained

Turning unstructured information into structured data

Current State	AI Assistance
Someone reads invoices manually and enters values into SAP or Excel	AI extracts vendor name, invoice number, amount, and due date automatically

Examples

- *Invoices*
- *Contracts*
- *Resumes*
- *Forms*
- *Emails*

Opportunity Signals

Manual entry • Repeated copying • Spreadsheet work • Review burden

Why This Matters

Extraction converts information into data that other workflows can use.



Capability & Agency Spectrum

Understanding how AI patterns move from information support toward greater action and agency



Guiding Philosophy

Not all AI use cases carry the same complexity, risk, or governance requirements.

The capability pattern alone does not determine risk. Risk and complexity depend on context, consequence, data, authority, integration, reversibility, and operating conditions.



Relationship to AI Operational Readiness

Understanding where use case classification fits within the methodology



Guiding Philosophy

AI use case categories help translate business opportunities into repeatable design patterns.



Business Problem → AI Pattern

Translating business language into AI capabilities

Business Problem	AI Pattern
Searching for policies	Search
Writing summaries	Summarization
Extracting contract terms	Extraction
Reviewing contracts for issues	Extraction + Risk Detection
Drafting emails	Drafting
Routing tickets	Classification + Routing
Identifying anomalies	Pattern Detection
Multi-step approvals	Agentic Workflow

Classification Record:

Opportunity – What prioritized opportunity are we classifying?

-

Primary Pattern – What's the principal capability?

-

Supporting Pattern(s) – What additional capabilities are needed?

-

Why this pattern fits – Why does the classification make sense?

-

Action Implication – Is the AI informing, recommending, coordinating, or acting? Action implications inform downstream workflow and decision-rights design.

-





AI OPERATIONAL READINESS

Bridging AI Access and AI Accountability

CURRENT-STATE → FUTURE-STATE FRAMEWORK

Designing AI-Enabled Work Responsibly



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Framework Overview

Designing AI-enabled work responsibly

Purpose

This framework helps teams translate prioritized AI opportunities into future-state workflows by mapping how work happens today, where friction exists, how AI may assist, where human oversight is required, and what business outcome the future state should create.

Core Flow

Current State → Pain Point → Opportunity → AI Assistance → Human Oversight → Business Outcome

What This Framework Helps Define

Component	Question It Answers
Current State	How does the work happen today?
Pain Point	What friction, delay, or burden exists?
Opportunity	What could be improved?
AI Assistance	What role could AI play?
Human Oversight	Where are reviews, approvals, escalations, interventions, or human accountability required?
Business Outcome	What business value should improve?
Resilience Check	What is the fallback path if the AI assistance becomes unavailable?

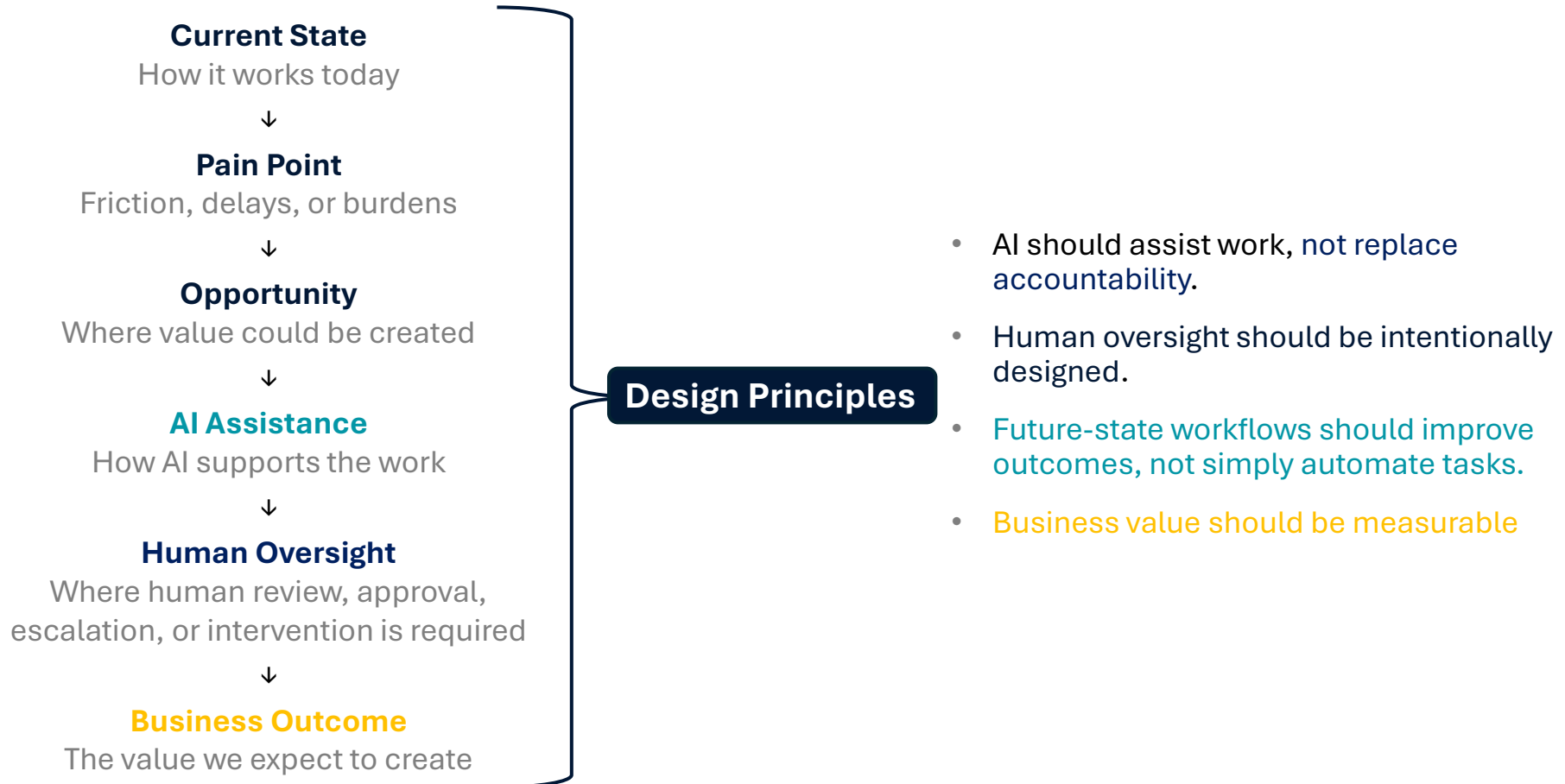
Guiding Philosophy

AI-enabled work should be designed before it is deployed.



The Flow

How work crosses from today's reality to tomorrow's value



Current State

Understanding how work happens today, including handoffs and workarounds

Current-State Elements	Proposed Design
Workflow: How the work is performed today, including handoffs and workarounds	
Inputs: Information, documents, systems, and data required.	
Outputs: Artifacts, decisions, reports, or actions produced.	
Dependencies: People, teams, approvals, or systems the work relies upon.	
Constraints: Pain points, delays, review burden, bottlenecks, or limitations.	

Opportunity Signals

Manual work • Multiple handoffs • Repeated searching • Spreadsheet dependency • Context switching • Tribal knowledge • Duplicate effort • Waiting

Why This Matters

Future-state workflows should begin with understanding today’s work, not with selecting AI capabilities.



Opportunity

Understanding what we are trying to improve

Opportunity Design Elements	Proposed Design
Intended Improvement	What should become faster, easier, more accurate, or more consistent.
Value Area	Productivity, quality, customer experience, risk reduction, cost, speed, or decision support.
AI Pattern	Primary and supporting capability pattern(s) identified during classification.
Action Implication	Inform, recommend, coordinate, act
Priority Signal	Why this opportunity was selected from the matrix.
Success Hypothesis	What we believe will improve if this opportunity is pursued.

Opportunity Signals

Repetition • Search burden • Review burden • Manual coordination • Handoffs • Drafting • Summarization • Decision support • Faster access to knowledge • Reduced rework

Why This Matters

AI opportunities should be defined around value creation, not tool capability.



AI Assistance

Understanding how AI supports the work

AI Design Elements	Proposed Design
AI Role	Search, summarization, drafting, etc.
Inputs Required	Information needed by AI
Outputs Produced	Artifacts created by AI
Boundaries & Failure Conditions	What AI should not do, where it may fail, and when the workflow should not rely on it
Handoff	Where AI output is passed to a person, system, or the next workflow step.
Human Interaction	Where people verify, modify, use, or respond to AI output.
Fallback Path	How does work continue if AI assistance is unavailable or unusable?

Opportunity Signals

Search • Summarization • Drafting • Classification • Extraction • Analysis • Recommendations • Workflow routing • Reporting • Monitoring • Repeated language or knowledge work

Why This Matters

AI should have a defined role in the workflow before it is introduced into the work.



Human Oversight

Understanding where accountability remains

Human Oversight Design Elements	Proposed Design
Review: Where must AI output be examined?	
Approval: Where must human authorization occur before work proceeds?	
Escalation: What conditions require the workflow to leave its normal path?	
Intervention Authority: Where must the workflow be capable of pausing, overriding, or stopping?	
Accountability: Where does consequential responsibility remain human?	

Opportunity Signals

High-consequence decisions • Sensitive information • Customer impact • Legal or compliance exposure • External-facing outputs • Escalation triggers • Required approvals • Disagreement between AI and human judgment

Why This Matters

Human-in-the-loop is not a governance model unless the loop defines who reviews, who approves, who escalates, who can intervene, and who remains accountable.



Business Outcome

Understanding what value should improve

Business Outcome Design Elements	Proposed Design
Success Measure	What metric will show whether the future state is working.
Expected Benefit	The value the team, customer, or business should receive.
Baseline	How the work performs today before AI is introduced.
Evidence Need	What would we need to observe to know whether the intended improvement occurred?
Success Condition	What would indicate that the future-state design is working as intended?

Opportunity Signals

Cycle time • Quality • Cost • Throughput • Customer outcome • Rework • Review Burden • Risk reduction • Consistency

Why This Matters

Future-state design should define the outcome AI is expected to improve and how that improvement will be recognized.



Future-State Blueprint

Summarizing the proposed design

Area	Proposed Design Summary
Current State	What work looks like today
Future-State Workflow	How work will operate with AI
AI Role	What AI does
Human Handoffs	Where people enter/ re-enter the workflow
Oversight Points	Where review, approval, escalation, or intervention is required
Dependencies	What the future state relies upon
Resilience / Fallback	How work continues when AI cannot
Business Outcome	What should improve

Next Steps

Define decision rights, evidence requirements, pilot readiness, and governance operating rhythm.



Example Future-State Profile

Illustrating the framework in practice

Opportunity: Meeting Summary Assistant

Area	Proposed Design Summary
Current State	Managers manually create meeting summaries and action items.
Opportunity	Reduce review burden and improve consistency.
AI Assistance	AI drafts summaries and extracts action items from meeting notes.
Human Oversight	Managers review and approve summaries before distribution. Escalation occurs for sensitive discussions. Managers remain accountable for communication.
Business Outcome	Reduce summary preparation time by 50% Increase follow-up consistency. Maintain quality through human review.

Design Element	Proposed Design
Future-state Workflow	AI drafts meeting summary and action items; manager reviews before distribution.
Primary Pattern	Summarization
Supporting Pattern(s)	Extraction
Action Implication	Inform
Inputs	Meeting transcript
Outputs	Draft summary and action items
Human Handoff	AI draft → Manager
Review Point	The manager verifies before distribution
Escalation Point	Sensitive topics leave the normal workflow for escalation
Fallback Path	Manager creates summary manually if AI assistance is unavailable
Success Measure	50% reduction in preparation effort, improved follow-up consistency



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DECISION RIGHTS FRAMEWORK

*Defining Who Decides,
So Accountability Remains Human*



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Framework Overview

Translating human oversight into operational controls

Purpose

Human oversight only becomes governance when organizations define who reviews, approves, escalates, intervenes, and remains accountable.

Core Decision Rights

Review • Approval • Escalation • Intervention Authority • Accountability • Lifecycle Decision Authority • Authority Modification/ Restoration

What This Framework Helps Define

Component	Question It Answers
Review	Who verifies AI outputs before they are used?
Approval	Who authorizes actions or decisions?
Escalation	What conditions require additional attention?
Intervention Authority	Who can pause, override, or stop the process?
Accountability	Who remains responsible for outcomes?
Lifecycle Decision Authority	Who can authorize scale, redesign, pause, or retirement?
Authority Modification / Restoration	Who can narrow, suspend, restore, or expand AI operating authority?

Guiding Philosophy

Human involvement does not equal human accountability.

Guiding Principle – Access ≠ Authority

Access to information, tools, or systems does not, by itself, establish authority to act. Permission to change, commit, transfer, trigger, or execute must be explicitly defined.



Why Human-in-the-Loop Isn't Enough

Understanding the difference between participation and accountability

Human in the loop	Operational Governance
Human touches output	Review responsibilities defined
Human judgement is assumed	Approval authority defined
Exceptions handled ad hoc	Escalation paths defined
Individuals intervene informally	Intervention authority defined
Ownership is ambiguous	Accountability defined

Human involvement without decision rights is participation, not governance.



Review

Understanding who examines outputs

Questions

- **Review Owner** – Who performs the review?
- **Verification Criteria** – What are they expected to check?
- **Review Timing/ Frequency** – When/how often must review occur?
- **Failure Response** – What happens when the output doesn't meet criteria?

Design Elements

Review Elements	Proposed Design
Review	
Review Frequency	
Validation Criteria	
Evidence Retained	
Escalation Trigger	

Review Signals

Outputs with customer impact • Sensitive information • High-consequence decisions • External communications
• Compliance exposure

Guiding Principle

Review defines how humans verify outputs before they become actions.



Approval

Understanding who authorizes use, distribution, execution, or exception

Questions

- What requires approval—use, distribution, execution, or exception?
- Who has authority to grant that approval?
- What conditions must be true for the approval to apply?
- What decisions must remain human?

Design Elements

Approval Elements	Proposed Design
Approval Owner – Who has the authority	
Approval Scope – Use/ Distribution/ Execution/ Exception	
Approval Conditions – What must be true for the approval to apply	
Threshold	
Approval method	
Exceptions	

Approval Signals

Irreversible actions • External commitments • Financial impact • Policy exceptions • Customer-facing outputs

Guiding Principle

Approval defines who authorizes actions before they occur.



Escalation

Understanding what triggers escalation, who receives it, and what response time applies

Questions

- What triggers escalation?
- Who receives escalations?
- How quickly should issues be addressed?
- What happens if escalation is unresolved?

Design Elements

Escalation Elements	Proposed Design
Escalation Trigger	
Escalation Recipient	
Response Time	
Escalation Method	
Resolution Path	

Escalation Signals

Unexpected outputs • Human disagreement • Confidence thresholds • Regulatory concerns • Customer complaints

Guiding Principle

Exceptions should have predefined paths before they occur.



Intervention Authority

Understanding who can pause, override, shut down, rollback and restart

Questions

- Who can pause?
- Who can override?
- Who can shut down the process?
- Who decides to revert to manual work?
- Who can authorize restart or restoration?

Design Elements

Intervention Elements	Proposed Design
Pause Authority	
Override Authority	
Shutdown / Disable Authority	
Rollback Procedure	
Restart / Restore Authority	

Intervene Signals

Repeated failures • Unsafe behavior • Business disruption • Loss of trust • Escalation breakdown

Guiding Principle

Authority should exist before it is needed. Stopping AI is only half the governance problem. Someone also has to possess legitimate authority to restore it.

Accountability

Understanding who owns outcomes and consequences

Questions

- Who owns the process?
- Who owns customer impact?
- Who owns errors?
- Who owns the consequences if something goes wrong?

Design Elements

Accountability Elements	Proposed Design
Process Owner	
Business Owner	
Risk & Compliance Owner	

Accountability Signals

Customer impact • Process ownership • Regulatory obligations • Cross-functional dependencies

Guiding Principle

Accountability remains human, even when work is AI-assisted. Supporting roles can be many, but ultimately accountability should be explicit.



Lifecycle & AuthorityDecisions

Defining who can change whether and how AI-enabled work continues

Lifecycle Decision Authority:

Questions

- Who can authorize scale, redesign, pause, or retirement?

Lifecycle Decision Elements	Proposed Design
Decision Owner	
Decision Scope – Scale / Redesign / Pause / Retire	
Decision Basis – What evidence or conditions inform the decision?	

Authority Modification / Restoration:

Questions

- Who can authorize changes to the AI’s permitted operating authority, including narrowing, suspending, restoring, or expanding it?

Authority Modification Elements	Proposed Design
Authority Owner	
Modification Scope – Narrow / Suspend / Restore / Expand	
Conditions / Evidence Required	



Example Decision Rights Profile

Illustrating the framework in practice

Opportunity: Meeting Summary Assistant

Decision Area	Proposed Design Summary
Review	Manager verifies summaries
Approval	Manager approves distribution
Escalation	Sensitive topics escalate to HR
Intervention Authority	Manager may disable AI assistance
Accountability	Manager remains accountable for communication quality
Lifecycle Decision Authority	Director determines expansion to additional teams
Authority Modification / Restoration	System owner authorizes restoration or changes to AI operating authority.

AI Action Boundary

What may AI do without additional authorization?

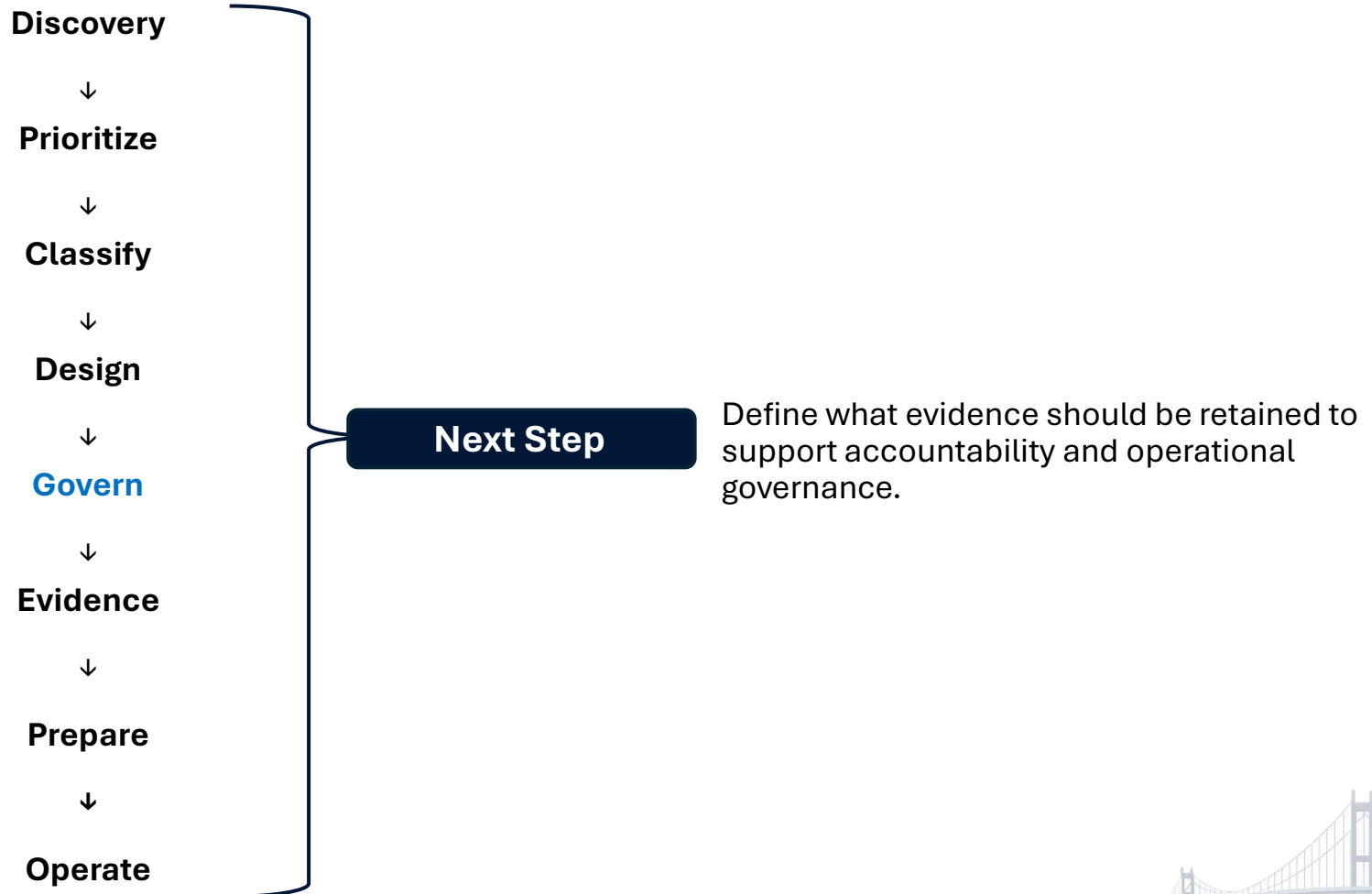
- **Action Level:** *Inform*
- **Permitted Action Boundary:** AI may draft summaries and action items but may not distribute them without human authorization.

Guiding Principle

Decision rights should be defined before AI-enabled work begins.



Decision Rights in the AI Operational Readiness Journey





AI OPERATIONAL **READINESS**

Bridging AI Access and AI Accountability

EVIDENCE FRAMEWORK

*Defining What Must Be Observed,
Retained, and Verified*



by **Chloe Devine**

AI STRATEGY • GOVERNANCE • OPERATIONAL READINESS

VERSION 2.0

Updated September 2026

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Framework Overview

Translating accountability into observable evidence

Purpose

Governance becomes operational when evidence can support, reconstruct, and test decisions and actions. The framework defines what to observe, retain, and verify across value, quality, risk, adoption, decisions, and governance.

Core Evidence Areas

Value • Quality • Risk • Adoption • Decision • Governance Provenance • Decision Provenance

What This Framework Helps Define

Component	Question It Answers
Value Evidence	Are we creating measurable value?
Quality Evidence	Are outputs meeting expectations?
Risk Evidence	Are issues or failures occurring?
Adoption Evidence	Is the solution being used effectively?
Decision	What information supports governance decisions?
Governance Provenance	What evidence establishes what was reviewed, approved, conditioned, mitigated, and owned?
Decision Provenance	Can we reconstruct why a consequential action or decision was considered legitimate?

Guiding Philosophy

Governance becomes operational when decisions are supported by evidence.



Why Evidence Isn't Optional

Understanding the difference between assumptions and observability

Assumption	Operational Evidence
AI seems useful	Value is measured
Quality is assumed	Quality is evaluated
Risk is unknown	Risks are monitored
Usage is uncertain	Adoption is measured
Decisions rely on opinion	Decisions rely on evidence
“We have logs”	Evidence can reconstruct the relevant decision and system state

Evidence Quality Check

- **Integrity** – Can alteration be detected?
- **Provenance** – Where did the evidence come from?
- **Traceability** – Can it be connected to the relevant decision?
- **Version Alignment** – Does it describe what was operating?
- **Continued Relevance / Freshness** – Does it still support the decision now?

Guiding Philosophy

Evidence makes operational decisions observable, supportable, and reconstructable.



Value Evidence

Understanding what business value is created

Questions

- What outcome should be improved?
- What baseline exists?
- How will value be measured?
- What constitutes success?

Design Elements

Value Elements	Proposed Design
Success Measure	
Baseline	
Target Improvement	
Measurement Frequency	
Reporting Owner	

Value Signals

Cycle time • Reduced effort • Cost reduction • Increased throughput • Customer satisfaction • Quality improvements

Guiding Principle

Value should be measurable before it is celebrated.



Quality Evidence

Understanding whether outputs meet expectations

Questions

- How is quality verified?
- What defects matter?
- What thresholds exist?
- How often is quality reviewed?

Design Elements

Quality Elements	Proposed Design
Quality Metric	
Acceptance Criteria	
Review Frequency	
Error Threshold	
Verification Owner	

Quality Signals

Corrections • Rework • Hallucinations • Inconsistent outputs • Escalations • User complaints

Guiding Principle

Quality should be demonstrated, not assumed.



Risk Evidence

Understanding where failures and concerns emerge

Questions

- What risks should be monitored?
- What incidents should be recorded?
- What thresholds trigger action?
- What trends matter?

Design Elements

Risk Elements	Proposed Design
Risk Metric	
Monitoring Frequency	
Escalation Threshold	
Incident Tracking	
Owner	

Risk Signals

Sensitive information • Compliance concerns • Customer impact • Repeated failures • Unexpected behavior • Policy/control exceptions • Threshold breaches

Guiding Principle

Risks should be observed before they become incidents.



Adoption Evidence

Understanding how people interact with the solution

Questions

- Is the solution being used?
- Are users bypassing it?
- Where does friction exist?
- Is trust increasing or declining?
- Has AI reduced work or shifted effort to reviewers?
- What human effort is required to verify, correct, or manage AI output?

Design Elements

Adoption Elements	Proposed Design
Usage Metric	
Satisfaction Measure	
Friction Indicator	
Training Need	
Adoption Owner	
Review Burden	

Adoption Signals

Low usage • Workarounds • Complaints • Declining trust • Shadow processes

Guiding Principle

Adoption reveals whether the design works in practice.



Decision Evidence

Understanding what evidence supports lifecycle and governance decisions

Questions

- What information supports scaling?
- What evidence supports pausing?
- What evidence supports redesigning?
- What evidence supports retirement?
- What rationale should be retained with the decision?

Design Elements

Decision Elements	Proposed Design
Scale Criteria	
Pause Criteria	
Redesign Criteria	
Retirement Criteria	
Decision Owner	
Decision Rationale	

Decision Signals

Declining quality • Escalations • Strong value • Weak adoption • Risk exposure

Guiding Principle

Governance decisions should rely on evidence, not optimism.



Governance & Decision Provenance

Preserving what was decided, why it was legitimate, and the conditions that applied

Governance Provenance Questions

- What governance decision was made?
- What evidence supported it?
- Who reviewed or approved it?
- What conditions, mitigations, or exceptions applied?
- What system/version did the decision apply to?

Evidence Elements	Proposed Design
Decision / Approval	
Supporting Evidence	
Owner / Approver	
Conditions / Mitigations	
Applicable Version / State	

Decision Provenance Questions

- Can we reconstruct why a consequential action was allowed to proceed?
- What evidence, context, policy, authority, and approval applied?
- What was executed, and what outcome resulted?

Evidence Elements	Proposed Design
Initiating Event / Request	
Evidence & Context	
Applicable Policy / Authority	
Approval / Exception / Override	
Action Executed	
Resulting Outcome	



Example Evidence Profile

Illustrating the framework in practice

Opportunity: Meeting Summary Assistant

Evidence Area	Proposed Design Summary
Value	50% reduction in summary preparation time
Quality	Manager correction rate <10%
Risk	Sensitive-topic escalation count and policy exception rate
Adoption	80% team utilization
Decision	Expand after three successful months
Governance Provenance	Manager approval, escalation decisions, applicable conditions, and workflow version retained
Decision Provenance	For consequential exceptions, retain the supporting evidence, applicable authority, decision, and resulting action.

Guiding Principle

Evidence should support decisions throughout the lifecycle.





AI OPERATIONAL READINESS

Bridging AI Access and AI Accountability

PILOT READINESS FRAMEWORK

*Determining Whether We Are Ready
to Pilot with Confidence*



by Chloe Devine

AI STRATEGY • GOVERNANCE • OPERATIONAL READINESS

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Framework Overview

Translating design, governance, and evidence into a pilot decision

Purpose

This framework determines whether an AI-enabled operating model is ready for controlled testing by verifying business fit, workflow design, technical readiness, governance, evidence, operational support, and pilot decision criteria.

Core Flow

Business Fit → Workflow Readiness → Technical Readiness → Governance Readiness → Evidence Plan → Operational Support → Pilot Decision

What This Framework Helps Define

Component	Question It Answers
Business Fit	Is this pilot worth running?
Workflow Readiness	Has the future-state workflow been defined?
Technical Readiness	Can the solution function reliably enough to test?
Governance Readiness	Are decision rights, escalation, and intervention defined?
Evidence Plan	Do we know what must be observed, retained, and verified?
Operational Support	Are people, support paths, and fallback plans ready?
Pilot Decision	Should we proceed, pause, redesign, or defer?

Guiding Philosophy

A pilot should test a defined operating model, not an undefined idea.



Why Pilots Fail

Understanding the difference between experimentation and readiness

Experimentation Without Readiness	Pilot Readiness
AI use case is interesting	Business problem is defined
Workflow is assumed	Future-state workflow is mapped
Human oversight is informal	Decision rights are assigned
Success is anecdotal	Evidence plan is defined
Issues are handled reactively	Escalation and fallback paths are prepared
Pilot starts because the tool works	Pilot starts because the operating model is ready
Fallback is assumed	Fallback is documented and testable
Controls exist on paper	Controls can be exercised

Guiding Philosophy

A working tool is not the same as a pilot-ready workflow.



Business Fit

Understanding whether the pilot is worth running

Questions

- What business problem does the pilot address?
- Why is this use case worth testing now?
- What value should the pilot create?
- Who is sponsoring the pilot?

Design Elements

Business Fit Elements	Proposed Design
Business Problem	
Intended Value	
Sponsor	
Success Hypothesis	
Priority Rationale	

Business Fit Signals

Clear pain point • High-frequency work • Strong business sponsor • Measurable outcome • Prioritized opportunity
• Clear user group

Guiding Principle

Pilots should be selected for business value, not tool novelty.



Workflow Readiness

Understanding whether the future-state workflow is defined

Questions

- Has the current state been documented?
- Has the future-state workflow been designed?
- Where does AI assist?
- Where do humans review, approve, or intervene?
- Is AI's permitted action boundary reflected in the workflow?
- What happens when the workflow encounters an exception?

Workflow Readiness Elements	Proposed Design
Current-State Workflow	
Future-State Workflow	
AI Role	
Human Handoff	
Fallback Path	
Action Boundary	
Exception Path	

Workflow Readiness Signals

Current-state ambiguity • Undefined handoffs • Missing fallback path • Manual workaround required • Human review unclear • Process owner uncertainty

Guiding Principle

AI should enter a designed workflow, not an assumed one.



Technical Readiness

Understanding whether the solution can function reliably enough to test

Questions

- What model, tool, or platform will be used?
- What inputs does the solution require?
- Are data, documents, and system connections available?
- What limitations or failure modes are expected?
- Can required approvals, pauses, restrictions, or intervention points actually be enforced in the pilot environment?
- Can the pilot produce the evidence needed to evaluate the workflow and governance model?

Technical Readiness Elements	Proposed Design
Tool / Model / Platform	
Required Inputs	
Integration Needs	
Known Limitations	
Test Environment	
Required Controls/Enforcement Points	
Required Observation/ Logging	

Technical Readiness Signals

Data access gaps • Poor input quality • Integration uncertainty • Model limitations • Unstable workflow • Security concerns

Guiding Principle

Technical readiness means the solution can be tested safely, not that it is perfect.



Governance Readiness

Understanding whether oversight is ready before launch

Questions

- Who reviews AI outputs?
- Who approves use or distribution?
- What triggers escalation?
- Who can pause, override, stop, or restore AI-enabled operation?
- Who remains accountable?
- Are approval conditions understood and reflected in the pilot?
- Who can suspend, restore, or modify AI operating authority during the pilot?

Governance Readiness Elements	Proposed Design
Review Owner	
Approval Owner	
Escalation Path	
Intervention Authority	
Accountability Owner	
Approval Conditions	
Authority Modification/ Restoration	

Governance Readiness Signals

Undefined review • Approval ambiguity • No escalation path • No pause criteria • Shared accountability • Sensitive or external-facing outputs

Guiding Principle

Oversight should be operational before the pilot begins.



Evidence Readiness

Understanding whether evidence can be produced and evaluated during the pilot

Questions

- What baseline exists?
- What evidence will show value?
- What evidence will show quality?
- What evidence will show risk?
- What evidence will support the scale decision?
- What evidence will show adoption and human review burden?
- What governance or decision evidence must be retained?
- How will required evidence be captured during the pilot?

Evidence Readiness Elements	Proposed Design
Baseline	
Value Metric	
Quality Metric	
Risk Metric	
Scale Criteria	
Adoption/Review Burden	
Governance/Decision Evidence	
Evidence Owner/Capture Method	

Evidence Readiness Signals

Missing baseline • Anecdotal success • Unclear quality threshold • No risk tracking • No adoption measure • No scale criteria

Guiding Principle

Evidence should be defined before the pilot produces results.



Operational Support

Understanding whether people and support paths are ready

Questions

- Who supports users during the pilot?
- How will issues be reported?
- What training or guidance is needed?
- What happens if the AI system becomes unavailable?
- How will lessons be captured?
- Has the fallback or recovery path been tested or walked through?

Operational Support Elements	Proposed Design
Support Owner	
User Guidance	
Issue Reporting Path	
Fallback / Continuity Plan	
Lessons Capture	
Fallback/Recovery Test	

Operational Support Signals

No support owner • Confused users • Silent failures • Workarounds • AI dependency • No fallback path • Lessons not captured • Untested fallback

Guiding Principle

A pilot should be supported as an operating workflow, not treated as a side experiment.



Pilot Boundaries & Learning Plan

Defining what will be tested, with whom, for how long, and what the pilot must teach us

Pilot Boundary Element Design

Questions

- Who and what is included in the pilot?
- What systems, data, workflows, or actions are in scope?
- What remains explicitly out of scope?
- How long will the pilot run?
- What conditions require the pilot to pause or stop?

Pilot Boundary Elements	Proposed Design
Pilot Population/User Group	
Workflow Scope	
System/Data Scope	
Duration	
Exclusions	
Stop/Pause Conditions	

Learning Plan Element Design

Questions

- What assumptions are we testing?
- What must we learn before scale is considered?
- What evidence would challenge the proposed operating model?

Learning Plan Elements	Proposed Design
Learning Questions	
Key Assumptions	
Evidence Required	
Review Point	
Decision After Pilot	



Pilot Decision

Understanding whether to proceed, pause, redesign, or defer

Questions

- Is the business case clear?
- Is the workflow defined?
- Are governance controls assigned and executable?
- Can the required evidence actually be captured and evaluated?
- Are support and fallback paths in place?
- What unresolved dependencies or conditions must be accepted before proceeding?

Pilot Decision Elements	Proposed Design
Proceed Criteria	
Pause Criteria	
Redesign Criteria	
Defer Criteria	
Decision Owner	
Unresolved Dependencies/Conditions	

Pilot Decision Signals

Clear sponsor • Defined workflow • Assigned decision rights • Evidence plan ready • Support owner identified • Fallback path available

Guiding Principle

Pilot readiness is a decision, not a feeling.



Example Pilot Readiness Profile

Illustrating the framework in practice

Opportunity: Meeting Summary Assistant

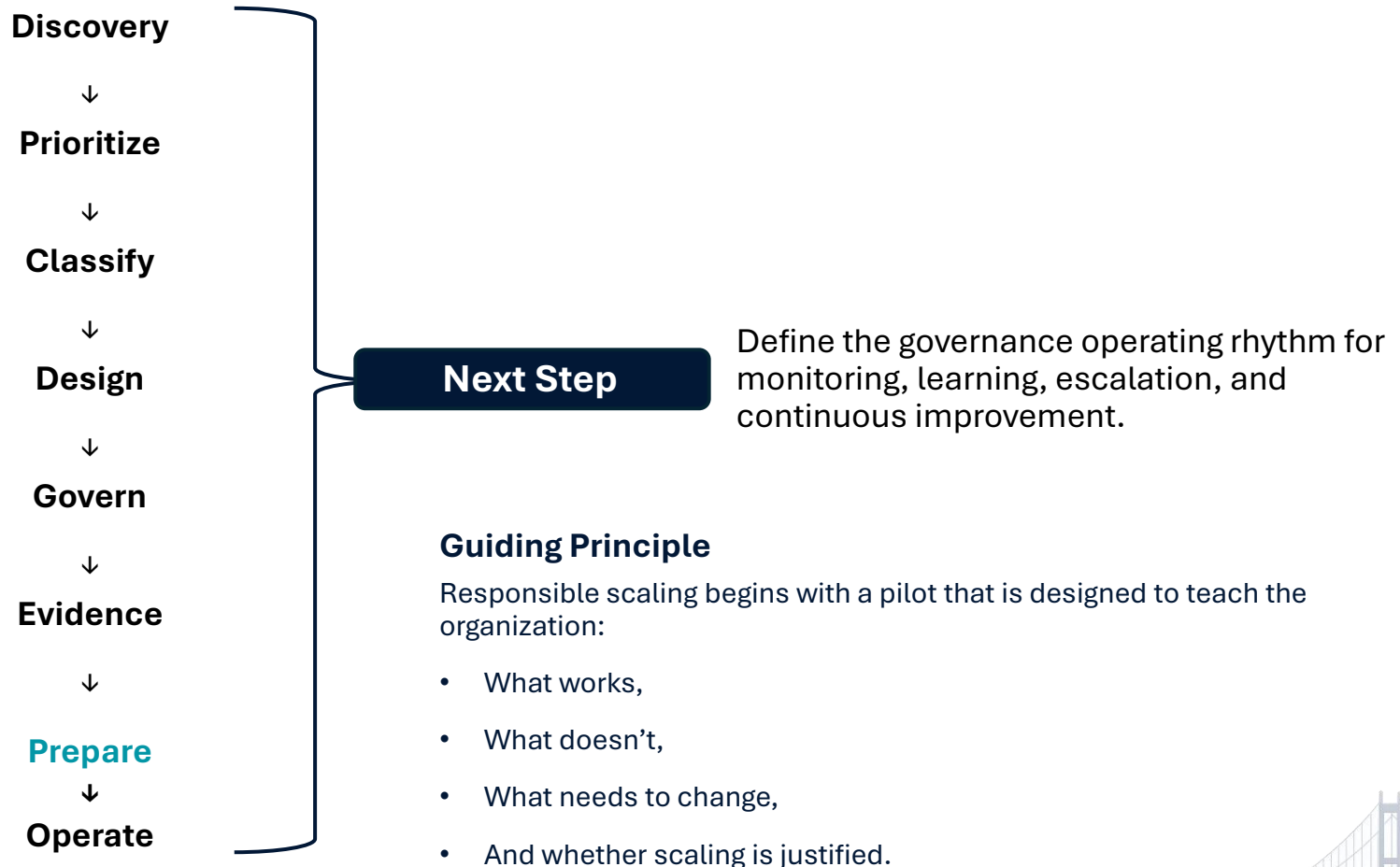
Readiness Area	Proposed Design Summary
Business Fit	Reduced summary preparation time and improved follow-up consistency.
Workflow Readiness	AI draft summaries; manager reviews before distribution
Technical Readiness	Meeting transcripts available; required logging enabled; pilot limited to internal meetings
Governance Readiness	Manager reviews and approves distribution, escalates sensitive topics, and may suspend AI assistance
Evidence Readiness	Track time saved, correction rate, user satisfaction, and escalation count
Operational Support	Provide user guidance, issue reporting path, and manual fallback
Pilot Decision	Proceed with 30-day internal pilot
Pilot Boundaries & Learning	30-day internal pilot with selected managers; test time savings, correction burden, escalation handling, and whether review controls work in practice.

Guiding Principle

A pilot should validate the workflow, controls, evidence, and value – not just the technology.



Pilot Readiness in the AI Operational Readiness Journey





AI OPERATIONAL **READINESS**

Bridging AI Access and AI Accountability

AI OPPORTUNITY **EXECUTIVE** **BRIEFING**

*Translating Analysis into
Executive Decisions*



by Chloe Devine

AI STRATEGY • GOVERNANCE • OPERATIONAL READINESS

VERSION 2.0

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Briefing Overview

Communicating the recommendation, rationale, and decision needed

Purpose

This briefing helps teams communicate a selected AI opportunity to executive stakeholders by summarizing the business problem, proposed future state, AI role, governance model, evidence plan, pilot readiness, and decision needed.

Core Flow

Problem → Opportunity → Design → Governance → Evidence → Readiness → Decision

What This Briefing Helps Communicate

Component	Question It Answers
Business Problem	What issue are we addressing?
Recommended Opportunity	What AI-enabled opportunity are we proposing?
Future-State Design	How will the work change?
Governance Model	Who reviews, approves, escalates, intervenes, and remains accountable?
Evidence Plan	How will value, qualify, risk, and adoption be measured?
Pilot Readiness & Recommendation	Are we ready to pilot, and what should we test and learn?
Decision Requested	What do we need leadership to approve?

Guiding Philosophy

Executive briefings should turn analysis into decisions.



Executive Summary

Providing the recommendation in one view

Briefing Area	Summary
Recommendation	Proceed with a limited pilot / defer / redesign
Opportunity	Name of AI opportunity
Business Value	Expected benefit
Governance	Key oversight model
Evidence	Measures to evaluate success
Decision Needed	Approval, funding, sponsorship, or alignment
Readiness	Key readiness condition, dependency, or limitation

Guiding Philosophy

Executives should understand the recommendation before they see the details.



Business Problem

Clarifying the problem before proposing AI

Questions

- What work is painful, slow, costly, risky, or inconsistent?
- Who is affected?
- What happens if this problem remains unresolved?
- What evidence supports the problem?

Problem Signals

Rework • Delays • Manual effort • Search burden • Review burden • Customer impact • Compliance exposure • Bottlenecks

Guiding Principle

AI should be proposed in response to a business problem, not as a standalone capability.



Current State

Showing how the work happens

Current-State Area	Summary
Workflow	How work happens today
Inputs	Information, documents, systems, or data used
Outputs	What the process produces
Dependencies	People, approvals, systems, or teams involved
Continuity/ Criticality	What work must continue if AI or a supporting dependency is unavailable?
Constraints	Pain points, delays, bottlenecks, or limitations

Guiding Principle

Executives should see the work before they approve changing it.



Recommended AI Opportunity

Explaining what should change and why this opportunity was selected

Opportunity Area	Summary
Opportunity	Proposed AI-enabled use case
Source Theme	Where it emerged from discovery
Priority Rationale	Why it scored high or was selected
AI Pattern	Primary AI pattern and supporting pattern(s)
Action/Authority Implication	Inform/Recommend/Coordinate/Act
Expected Improvement	What should become faster, easier, safer, or more consistent.

Opportunity Signals

High frequency • High pain • Strong AI fit • Measurable value • Manageable risk • Clear sponsor

Guiding Principle

The best AI opportunities balance value, fit, complexity, and risk.



Future-State Design

Showing how work will change with AI assistance

Future-State Area	Summary
AI Role	What AI will do
Human Role	What humans will review, approve, or decide
Workflow Change	How the process changes
Human Handoff	Where AI assistance ends
Fallback Path	What happens if AI is unavailable or unsuitable
Review/Approval Point	Where review or authorization occurs before consequential action
Success Outcome	What should materially improve if the design works

Guiding Principle

Future-state workflows should improve outcomes, not simply automate tasks.



Governance Model

Defining who decides and where accountability remains

Decision Area	Proposed Design
Review	Who verifies outputs
Approval	Who authorizes use or distribution
Escalation	What triggers escalation and who receives it
Intervention Authority	Who can pause, override, or stop the process
Accountability	Who owns outcomes and consequences
AI Action Boundary	What AI may do without additional authorization
Authority Modification/ Restoration	Who may narrow, suspend, restore, or expand AI operating authority

Governance Signals

Sensitive information • External-facing outputs • High-consequence decisions • Shared ownership • Escalation triggers • Compliance exposure

Guiding Principle

Human involvement without decision rights is participation, not governance.



Evidence Plan

Defining how success, quality, risk, and adoption will be measured

Evidence Area	Measure
Value	Time saved, cost reduced, throughput increased, quality improved
Quality	Accuracy, correction rate, acceptance rate, rework
Risk	Escalations, incidents, sensitive outputs, unexpected behavior
Adoption	Usage, satisfaction, workarounds, trust
Decision Evidence	Evidence required to scale, pause, redesign, or retire
Governance	Approvals, escalations, interventions, exceptions, and authority changes

Guiding Principle

Governance decisions should rely on sufficient, trustworthy evidence – not optimism.



Pilot Readiness & Recommendation

Defining whether the organization is ready to test and what the pilot should learn

Pilot Area	Recommendation
Scope	Team, process, use case, or timeframe
Participants	Pilot users and support owners
Duration	Proposed pilot length
Success Criteria	What would justify scaling
Pause Criteria	What would require stopping or redesign
Learning Goals	What the pilot is designed to teach the organization
Readiness Conditions	What must be true before the pilot begins
Review Point	When evidence will be reviewed and who decides what happens next

Pilot Signals

Defined scope • Clear sponsor • Assigned decision rights • Evidence plan ready • Support path defined • Fallback path available

Guiding Principle

A pilot should validate the workflow controls, evidence, and value, not just the technology.



Risk, Dependencies, and Open Questions

Clarifying what must be managed before approval

Area	Consideration	Owner / Next Step
Risk	Key risk or concern	
Dependency	System, data, team, vendor, or policy dependency	
Open Question	Decision or clarification needed	
Mitigation	Planned control or response	
Continuity	Critical dependency, fallback, or recovery concern.	

Guiding Principle

Unresolved risks should be visible before decisions are made.



Decision Requested

Making the executive ask explicit

Decision Needed	Recommendation
Proceed / Pause / Redesign / Defer	Recommended decision
Approve Pilot Scope	Scope and boundaries
Confirm Sponsor	Executive or business sponsor
Confirm Owners	Process, governance, technical, and support owners
Confirm Next Step	Workshop, pilot, funding, or design completion
Confirm Decision Authority	Who can approve, pause, redesign, scale or retire

Guiding Principle

Executive briefings should end with a clear decision, not a general discussion.



Next Steps

Translating executive direction into action

Next Step	Owner	Timing
Finalize pilot scope		
Confirm decision rights		
Define evidence collection		
Prepare support, fallback, and continuity paths		
Schedule pilot review		

Guiding Principle

The value of an executive briefing is measured by the clarity of the next action.



About this Toolkit

Companion Resource

This toolkit is designed to be used with the *AI Operational Readiness and Governance Practitioner Guide*.

For the complete methodology, principles, and lifecycle content, access the Practitioner Guide here:

[Access the AI Operational Readiness & Governance Practitioner Guide on Zenodo](#)

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AI Assistance Disclosure

AI tools supported research synthesis, content organization, editing, and design assistance in developing this resource. The framework, methodology, practitioner guidance, and final editorial decisions were developed and reviewed by Chloe C. Devine.

Practitioner Notice

This resource provides practical guidance and templates and is not a substitute for legal, regulatory, security, compliance, or other professional advice. Organizations should adapt its application to their specific context, risks, policies, and obligations.

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